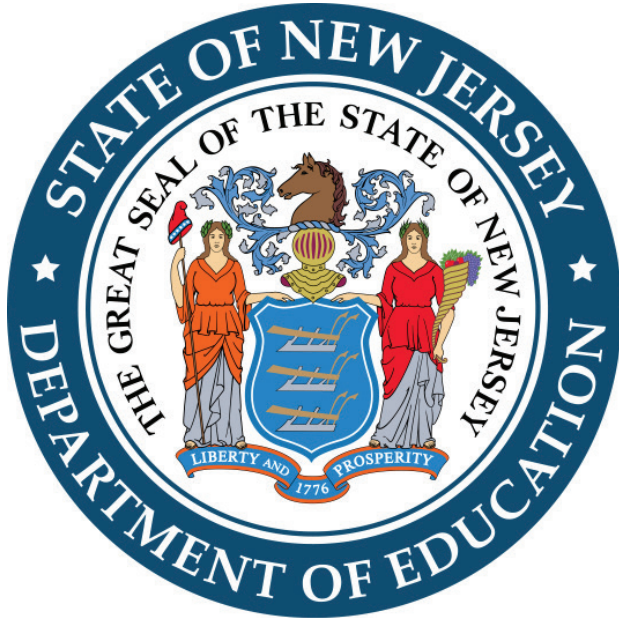




New Jersey
Student Learning
Assessments-Adaptive

Practice Test

English Language Arts

Grade 7

Student Name _____

Directions:

Today, you will take the Grade 7 English Language Arts Practice Test. If you do not know the answer to a question, skip it and go on to the next question. If you have time, go back to the questions you skipped and try to answer them before turning in your Student Test Booklet.

1. Read each passage and question. Then, follow the directions to answer each question.
2. Fill in the circle next to your answer choice or choices.
 - If you change your answer, make sure you erase your old answer completely.
 - Do not cross out or make any marks on the other choices.
3. One of the questions will ask you to write your answer.
 - Write your answer in the space provided in your Student Test Booklet.
 - Be sure to keep your answer within the provided space.

Rebecca is about to leave for college in New York City. She has recently found out that her family will be moving to be close to her.

from *Return to Me*

by Justina Chen

- 1 So now, two days before my family exodus for the East Coast, my dad and I were enjoying one final campout in my treehouse. Our once-a-summer tradition had begun when we moved to Lewis Island, a twenty-minute ferry ride from Seattle. The only change in our fifteen-year tradition had been to swap our old, dark tent for a newly built treehouse when I turned ten.
- 2 I woke this morning to Dad waving the remains of our half-eaten bag of Cheetos under my nose. "Breakfast?" he asked, crunching a cheese curl noisily in my ear.
- 3 "Thanks," I said, and grabbed one, even though I wasn't particularly hungry. Only then did I gaze up into the cloud-filled skylight. Last night, stargazing was as much an act of futility as imagining some semblance of independence at college in two months. It was all too easy to picture my mom "dropping in" for a visit because she was "in the neighborhood." Before I knew it, she'd be color-coding my future roommate's binders and rearranging my closet into ready-made outfits. The overcast night sky had flattened into a slate of mourning-dove gray. I rolled onto my side to face Dad. "I'm going to miss this place."
- 4 "Trust me, you'll be so busy at college, you won't even think twice about any of this," he said, waving one arm as if to brush away my treehouse, my home, and my life as I had always known it.
- 5 Ninety-nine percent of the time, I agreed with Dad, but on the topic of my treehouse, we disagreed. It probably sounds stupid, but we hadn't even moved and I was already homesick for this tiny nest that housed all my architecture books and sketchbooks. The bunting I had sewn and strung above the windows with my favorite paint swatches. The photos of me flanked by all my male cousins and uncles. And best of all, the models I'd constructed at the summer camp I attended two years ago through the architecture school at the University of Washington—the birdhouse, artist studio, and modern shack. These were the projects that made me fall in love hard and fast with architecture
- 6 I cleared my throat to ward off the threat of tears and managed a wry smile for my father. "No offense, but I would have been more excited if I was going to college by myself."

- 7 “None taken.” Dad smiled indulgently at me, his gentle brown eyes crinkling at the corners. Other than a few strands of gray along his temples, at forty-five he looked virtually the same as the broad-shouldered high school football star he’d been. Days ago, Mom had removed the photos of Dad’s good old days from his man-cave office and mummified them in biodegradable newsprint for the cross-country move. My treehouse was one of the last rooms to be dismantled today, according to her well-executed moving plan. Dad continued, “I totally understand that a fresh start is something we all need at one point or another. . . .
- 8 “At least I talked your mom into moving to New Jersey instead of New York. That’ll give you some breathing room, right?” Dad said, crumpling the empty bag of Cheetos before tossing it carelessly onto the floor from the warmth of his sleeping bag.
- 9 “You have no idea how much I appreciate that,” I said fervently, only now eating my cheese curl.
- 10 The clock my grandpa George had given me . . . ticked loudly in the silence that followed my crunching.

Excerpt from *Return to Me* by Justina Chen. Copyright © 2013 by Justina Chen. Reprinted by permission of Little, Brown Books for Young Readers via Copyright Clearance Center.

1. How does the passage's setting affect the plot?
- Ⓐ Being outside helps Rebecca to relax despite her concerns about leaving home.
 - Ⓑ Being in the treehouse makes Rebecca consider what she will miss after moving away.
 - Ⓒ Being alone with her father leads Rebecca to confess her frustration with her mother's actions.
 - Ⓓ Being around her sketchbooks causes Rebecca to question whether she should pursue architecture.
2. What does the phrase act of futility mean as it is used in paragraph 3?
- Ⓐ useless effort
 - Ⓑ exciting activity
 - Ⓒ satisfying event
 - Ⓓ hopeless decision

3. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

Which sentence describes Rebecca and her father?

- Ⓐ They are often apart.
- Ⓑ They like to joke around.
- Ⓒ They enjoy a close relationship.
- Ⓓ They share a dream for the future.

Part B

Select **two** sentences from the passage that support the answer in Part A.

- Ⓐ "The only change in our fifteen-year tradition had been to swap our old, dark tent for a newly built treehouse . . ." (paragraph 1)
- Ⓑ "I woke this morning to Dad waving the remains of our half-eaten bag of Cheetos under my nose." (paragraph 2)
- Ⓒ "Ninety-nine percent of the time, I agreed with Dad, but on the topic of my treehouse, we disagreed." (paragraph 5)
- Ⓓ "I cleared my throat to ward off the threat of tears and managed a wry smile for my father." (paragraph 6)
- Ⓔ "'No offense, but I would have been more excited if I was going to college by myself.'" (paragraph 6)

4. How does the author contrast Rebecca's and her father's points of view?
- Ⓐ by showing that Rebecca feels guilty for wanting to be far from her parents while her father wishes they could be closer
 - Ⓑ by showing that Rebecca's father wants to continue their camping tradition while Rebecca is less concerned about the change
 - Ⓒ by showing how Rebecca thinks her father wants to move but then revealing that he would actually prefer to remain in their current house
 - Ⓓ by showing that Rebecca's father understands that Rebecca wants independence but underestimates how much she will miss her current house
5. What does the phrase "breathing room" in paragraph 8 express?
- Ⓐ Rebecca hopes to have better air quality.
 - Ⓑ Rebecca needs distance from her parents.
 - Ⓒ Rebecca appreciates her new independence.
 - Ⓓ Rebecca wants more space in her college room.
6. Select **three** statements that should be included in a summary of the passage.
- Ⓐ Rebecca attempts to go stargazing.
 - Ⓑ Rebecca enjoys a snack with her father.
 - Ⓒ Rebecca discusses missing her treehouse.
 - Ⓓ Rebecca reflects on her camping tradition.
 - Ⓔ Rebecca surveys the items in her treehouse fondly.
 - Ⓕ Rebecca wonders where her family will live next year.

7. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

Which theme is developed in the passage?

- Ⓐ Leaving the familiar behind can make a person sad.
- Ⓑ Accepting family members as they are can be a relief.
- Ⓒ Students can be proud after setting and achieving a goal.
- Ⓓ People should rely on others for help in challenging times.

Part B

Which sentence from the passage helps to develop the theme in Part A?

- Ⓐ "It probably sounds stupid, but we hadn't even moved and I was already homesick for this tiny nest that housed all my architecture books and sketchbooks." (paragraph 5)
- Ⓑ "And best of all, the models I'd constructed at the summer camp I attended two years ago through the architecture school at the University of Washington . . ." (paragraph 5)
- Ⓒ "'At least I talked your mom into moving to New Jersey instead of New York.'" (paragraph 8)
- Ⓓ "'You have no idea how much I appreciate that,' I said fervently . . ." (paragraph 9)

Directions:

Read the writing prompt and sources. Then write your final essay on pages 15 through 17. Check over your essay when you are finished.

Writing Prompt

Write an essay for your school newspaper arguing whether playing video games significantly affects physical health. Your essay must be based on the ideas, concepts, and information that can be determined through analysis of the “Do Video Games Have a Major Effect on Players’ Physical Health?” sources.

Manage your time carefully so that you can

- read the sources;
- plan your response;
- write your response; and
- revise and edit your response.

Be sure to

- include a claim;
- address counterclaims;
- use evidence from multiple sources; and
- avoid overly relying on one source.

Your response should be in the form of a multiparagraph essay. Write your response in the space provided.

Do Video Games Have a Major Effect on Players' Physical Health?

Source 1: Action-Packed Video Games a Sight for Sore Eyes

by Lisa Stein

- 1 Could it be? Could playing video games . . . be good for something? Studies have linked nonstop video gaming to such ills as carpal tunnel syndrome¹ and tennis elbow, not to mention the current obesity epidemic plaguing this nation's young.
- 2 On the positive side, some research has shown that playing video games can improve eye-hand coordination and visual attention—the ability to search for a target in a jungle of objects, to monitor several items at once, and to keep track of a steady stream of objects zipping swiftly by.
- 3 And now comes more good news for video game aficionados.² A new study . . . in the journal *Psychological Science*, shows that playing fast-paced, action-filled video games significantly sharpens vision
- 4 The reason? "Action video game play changes the way our brains process visual information," says study author Daphne Bavelier, noting that after just 30 hours, video gamers showed "a substantial increase in the spatial resolution of their vision." Translation: "They could see figures like those way down on an eye chart more clearly," she says, "even when other symbols crowded in."
- 5 Bavelier, an associate professor of brain and cognitive sciences at the University of Rochester, says the findings are helping scientists design a way to aid people with amblyopic or "lazy" eye.³ . . .
- 6 "We think action video game playing trains the same part of the visual cortex (located in the back of the brain) as that which has a dysfunction⁴ in people with lazy eye," Bavelier says. "This is showing us a new path forward for rehabilitation with these games"

¹carpal tunnel syndrome: an injury to a nerve in the wrist

²aficionados: people who really enjoy something

³"lazy" eye: reduced vision in one eye caused when the brain and eye do not work together properly

⁴dysfunction: the state of not working properly

- 7 She notes that researchers were surprised by the findings, because it was previously believed that the adult visual cortex could not easily be retrained or taught new things. And yet, the results indicate that is exactly what happened. . . .
- 8 But lest you think that is an excuse to start playing video games all the time—forget it. “There’s more to life than vision,” Bavelier chuckles. Besides, she notes, obsessive play will not necessarily lead to benefits, even in people with lazy eye. “It needs to be done properly,” she says about integrating video games into a treatment plan. “Usually people only have one amblyopic eye. We need to train the bad eye to become better, and the two eyes need to work together.”

Excerpt from “Action-Packed Video Games a Sight for Sore Eyes” by Lisa Stein, from *Scientific American*.
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Source 2: Video Games and Physical Health

by Joseph Green

- 9 There’s no doubt about it: young people love video games. A 2008 Pew Internet & American Life study reported that 97% of Americans ages 12 to 17 play video games. That’s a lot of people! But how might this gaming affect their physical health?
- 10 Some people play video games for too long. They hold their body in one position for hours. They perform the same movements over and over. This tension¹ and repetition can strain body parts such as the neck, wrist, or elbow. The strain can cause pain. However, in many cases the pain doesn’t last. It goes away if people stop playing the games so much.
- 11 Video games have also been blamed for the rise in obesity. People may choose video games over physical activity. This problem can be avoided by making time for physical activity. Also, some video games can actually help people be more physically active. These games allow players to move their bodies to control the game. Some people say these games don’t have the same benefits as “real” physical activity. Others see them as a good way to encourage people to move more.

¹tension: the condition of being stretched tight

- 12 Playing video games may lead to some health problems. But many of these problems occur when the games are played excessively. Moderate game playing doesn't usually harm people's physical health over the long term.

"Video Games and Physical Health" by Joseph Green. Written for educational purposes.

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FINAL COPY

Lined area for writing.



Paper Practice Test Answer and Alignment Document: ELA

Grade 7 Reading

Passage: from *Return to Me*

Item Sequence	Answer Key	Standards Alignment
1	B	RL.IT.7.3
2	A	L.VL.7.3
3	Part A: C Part B: A, C	RL.CR.7.1
4	D	RL.PP.7.5
5	B	L.VI.7.4
6	C, D, E	RL.CI.7.2
7	Part A: A Part B: A	RL.CI.7.2

Grade 7 Writing

Source 1: Action-Packed Video Games a Sight for Sore Eyes

Source 2: Video Games and Physical Health

1	Refer to the grade 6-8 argumentative writing rubric.	W.AW.7.1
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